

SOC INCIDENT — IOC REPORT

Phishing Email Forensics — Email Header Analysis & IP Investigation

Analyst: Sojwal Jichkar | Date: 23 May 2026 | Severity: **HIGH** | Status: **CONFIRMED PHISHING**

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A phishing email impersonating DocuSign was investigated using MXToolbox, VirusTotal, and AbuseIPDB. Email header analysis confirmed complete authentication failure — SPF, DKIM, and DMARC all returned FAIL results, proving the sender domain was spoofed. The sending IP (185.199.108.153) was flagged by 3 threat intelligence engines on VirusTotal and has been globally reported 18 times on AbuseIPDB with a 39% abuse confidence score. This email is a confirmed credential harvesting phishing attack.

2. ATTACK DETAILS

Field	Value
From (Display)	DocuSign Team
From (Actual)	no-reply@docusign-secure.com
Real DocuSign Domain	docusign.com — NOT docusign-secure.com
Subject	Secure Document - Please Review
Date	Tue, 14 May 2024 10:21:00 -0700
Sending IP	185.199.108.153
Target	victim@gmail.com — Corporate email users
Attack Type	Credential Harvesting via Fake Login Page

3. EMAIL HEADER ANALYSIS — MXTOOLBOX

Tool used: MXToolbox Email Header Analyzer (mxtoolbox.com/EmailHeaders.aspx)

Check	Result	Meaning
SPF	FAIL	Sending server not authorized by domain owner — spoofed sender
DKIM	FAIL	No valid digital signature — email not sent by real DocuSign
DMARC	FAIL	Domain policy violated — email should have been blocked

4. IP REPUTATION ANALYSIS

Tools used: VirusTotal + AbuseIPDB

Tool	Result	Details
VirusTotal	3 / 72 engines flagged	Flagged as malicious by 3 threat intelligence vendors
AbuseIPDB	39% Confidence of Abuse	Moderately malicious — block recommended
AbuseIPDB	18 global reports	Reported by 18 organizations worldwide
Location	San Francisco, USA	US cloud infrastructure used to evade geo-blocking

5. INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE (IOC TABLE)

IOC Type	Value	Finding
Domain	docusign-secure.com	Spoofed domain impersonating DocuSign
Email Address	no-reply@docusign-secure.com	Spoofed sender — SPF DKIM DMARC all FAIL
IP Address	185.199.108.153	3/72 flagged, 39% abuse, 18 global reports
URL	http://secure-docverify.com/login	Phishing login page — HTTP not HTTPS
Mail Server	mail.secure-docverify.com	Not a DocuSign authorized mail server

6. MITRE ATT&CK MAPPING

Tactic	Technique	Description
TA0001 Initial Access	T1566.002 Spearphishing Link	Phishing email with malicious URL to steal credentials
TA0001 Initial Access	T1078 Valid Accounts	Impersonating legitimate DocuSign brand identity
TA0005 Defense Evasion	T1583 Cloud Infrastructure	Using US-based cloud server to avoid geo-blocking

7. RECOMMENDATIONS

- Block sender domain docusign-secure.com in email gateway immediately
- Block sending IP 185.199.108.153 at firewall level
- Block phishing URL [http://secure-docverify.com/login](#) in web proxy
- Alert all organization users about this DocuSign impersonation campaign
- Add detection rule in SIEM: alert when email from docusign-secure.com is received
- Monitor for any users who may have clicked the phishing link
- Escalate to L2 for deeper investigation if any user clicked the URL

8. PERSONAL ANALYST OBSERVATION

My Own Observations During This Investigation:

When I first saw this email, the subject line — "Secure Document - Please Review" — immediately appeared suspicious to me. The subject line was designed to create urgency and catch attention, which is a classic social engineering tactic.

When I analyzed the email header in MXToolbox, I found that SPF, DKIM, and DMARC all failed. At that moment I was accurately and surely able to confirm that this email is a phishing email targeting the victim. No legitimate company email fails all three authentication checks simultaneously.

When I found 18 global reports on AbuseIPDB, this further confirmed to me that this is a malicious phishing attack. 18 different organizations around the world have already reported this same IP — which means this is an active, ongoing campaign, not an isolated incident.

9. ANALYST STATEMENT

"I found that this email is malicious because the subject line appeared suspicious. When I analyzed the

email header using MXToolbox, I found that SPF failed, DKIM failed, and DMARC also failed. This confirms that the sender domain was spoofed and this is a confirmed phishing email targeting the victim. IP analysis on VirusTotal and AbuseIPDB further confirmed the sending IP has been reported 18 times globally with a 39% abuse confidence score. Immediate blocking of all IOCs is recommended."

— Sojwal Jichkar, SOC L1 Analyst | 23 May 2026